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"APPROVED" by
the Board of the Public Organization
Women Center "Support, Protection and Care"
on 17.01.2022

FRAUD PREVENTION POLICY

INTRODUCTION

Public Organization Women Center "Support, Protection and Care" (SPC) has strict policy on fraud of any type or in any circumstances, whether carried out by persons associated with SPC (Board Members, management, staff or volunteers) or partner organisations, contractors or service users. Fraud against SPC depletes funds intended for the accomplishment of programme delivery, undermines effective functioning and jeopardises sustainable development by diverting donor contributions.

Fraud in favour of SPC affects our reputation and ability to attract donations. Vigorous and prompt investigations will be carried out into all reported cases (complaints) of actual or suspected fraud.

This policy is applicable to SPC partner organisations, consultants and other third parties contracted to provide services to SPC.

DEFINITION OF FRAUD/CORRUPTION

Abuse of data, resources or services that a person has at their actual disposal for the performance of a duty for the benefit of SPC, resulting from their employment with SPC, or for the performance of duties or the supply of goods.

For the purposes of this policy, fraud shall include, but not be limited to:

- Theft or misappropriation of SPC assets.
- Submitting false claims for payment or reimbursement.

- Accepting or offering a bribe, or accepting gifts or other favours under circumstances that might lead to the inference that the gift or favour was intended to influence an employee's decision-making while serving SPC.
- Accepting a commission from, or paying same to a third party (kickbacks).
- Blackmail or extortion.
- "Off book" accounting, or making false or fictitious entries.
- Knowingly creating and/or distributing false or misleading financial reports.
- Payment of excessive prices or fees where justification thereof is not documented.
- Violation of foundation procedures with the aim of personal gain or to the financial detriment of SPC.
- A dishonourable, or irresponsible, or deliberate act against the interest of SPC.

PREVENTION AND MONITORING

Partner organisations are expected to prevent and combat fraud and corruption in SPC-supported projects. Possible actions include:

- Taking all appropriate measures to prevent fraud and corruption on the project, such as maintaining appropriate fiduciary and administrative arrangements.
- Raising awareness, making sure that the SPC's Fraud Prevention Policy is made available to project staff.
- Reporting allegations of fraud and corruption in connection with the use of grants from SPC and cooperating with SPC investigations.
- If fraud or corruption does occur in a SPC-supported project, taking timely and appropriate action to address the problem.

For the execution of projects and programmes, SPC enters into agreements with partner organisations. The Agreement records the specific obligations of the partner organisation and SPC. Monitoring is carried out through financial reports, narrative reports and visits to the partner organisations and actual project sites. SPC makes use of the external audit of partner organisations, carried out by an internationally recognized auditor.

In addition, the SPC can provide extra monitoring with regard to fraud. A specific project or programme audit can also be carried out, as stipulated in the Agreement.

HOW TO HANDLE FRAUD

The person first confronted with a case of (suspected) fraud shall report this immediately to the Director and the Head of Finance of SPC. The following procedure is applicable:

- Payments to the partner organisation will be stopped immediately.
- Should an advance payment be underway, the Head of Finance of SPC will seek to retrieve the sum in question, where possible, with the aid of the principal banker.
- The Director will notify the partner organisation in writing that payments have been suspended and that:
    - the execution of the entire agreement will be suspended, giving a detailed explanation, and
    - SPC expects total clarification before resumption of the payments can be considered.

- After receiving a report and recommendations from those investigating the case, the Director will decide on whether the relationship with the partner organisation should be terminated or, after improvement measures have been taken, can still be continued.
- Conditions set by SPC for continuation of the relationship might entail that:
    - the full extent of the damage is determined by SPC or a third party; o the incidents are reported to the local authorities;
    - the partner organisation demonstrably improves internal organisation and monitoring;
    - parties involved in the fraud will be suspended or fired.